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COURSE OBJECTIVE

This course is centered on transnational corporations. The organizational challenges they face and the managerial implications implicit in these challenges. Students should be provided with a basic understanding of how to conduct business through different borders and cultures. The managerial challenges and opportunities that multinationals face, the formulation and assessment of different entry strategies, organizational structures and control issues, and finally, how to assess leadership and motivation issues within a global context in international business career tracks.

METHODOLOGY

Textbook, readings and cases will all be used. A significant amount of teamwork in the course is required since cases will mostly be handled in this manner. Students are required to read, analyze and prepare reading materials for each class and / or team meeting.

PROGRAM

Session 1: Greet & meet, rules of the course, individual expectations, team formation (August 12th)

Structure of the course, grading policy

Review of case method

Evaluation format for team presentations of cases

Dashman case reading & discussion (individual: to be hand out in class)

Team formation

Session 2: Expanding abroad: motivations, means and mentalities (August 19th)

Read chapter 1 of the textbook

Prepare reading 1-2: Distance still matters: The hard reality of global expansion (R0108K)

Prepare case 1-3: Mahindra & Mahindra in South Africa (W11547) / **Team 1**

Session 3: Understanding the international context (August 26th)

Read chapter 2 of textbook

Read article: Managing risk in an unstable world (R0506B)

Prepare case 2-2: The globalization of CEMEX (701017) / **Team 2**

Session 4: Developing Transnational Strategies (September 2nd)

Read chapter 3 of textbook

Reading 3-3: New Business Models in emerging markets (R1101E)

Prepare case 3-2: United Cereal: Lora Brill's Eurobrand challenge (4269) / **Team 3**

Session 5: Developing a transnational organization (September 9th)

Read chapter 4 of textbook

Reading 4-3: Matrix management: Not a structure, a frame of mind (90401)

Prepare case Kent Chemical: Organizing for international growth (4409) / **Team 4**

Session 6: Implementing the strategy: Building Multidimensional Capabilities (September 23rd)

Read chapter 5 of textbook

Reading 5-3: How to build collaborative advantage (SMR150)

Prepare case 5-3: McKinsey & Company: Managing knowledge and learning (396357) / **Team 5**

Session 7: Engaging in Cross border collaboration: Managing across corporate boundaries (September 30th)

Read chapter 6 of textbook

Prepare case 6-3: Eli Lilly in India: Rethinking the joint venture strategy (904M16) / **Team 6**

Session 8- Mid-Term exam (October 7th)

Individual evaluation of team member performance

Session 9- Mabe: Learning to be a Multinational (9B13M042)* / Teams 1&2 (October 14th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) What should Ramiro Perez do?
- 2) What lessons has Mabe learned for future international expansions?
- 3) Would another emerging market have been a better choice than Russia?

Guest Speaker

Session 10- Mabe: Learning to be a Multinational (B)* (9B15M121) Teams 3&4 (October 21st)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) Should the action learning team recommend an entry to the Indian market?
- 2) If the recommendation is to enter, what should Mabe entry strategy be?
- 3) What lessons has Mabe learned that it could apply to future expansion decisions?

Session 11- Sher Wood Hockey Sticks: Global Sourcing (W12669)/ Teams 5&6 (October 28th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) What decision factors changed between 2007 and 2011?
- 2) Should Sher Wood outsource its remaining operations to China?
- 3) What are the pros and cons of each option for Sher Wood

Session 12- Amazon in Emerging Markets (W94C01) / Teams 1&2 (November 4th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) Did Amazon succeed in China? What did it learn?
- 2) How would you rate Amazon's entry strategy choices into emerging markets? Explain
- 3) How should companies and investors measure success in emerging markets?

Session 13- GM: The Opel decision (910M22) / Teams 3&4 (November 11th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) How should the board evaluate each course of action?
- 2) How should the board evaluate each bid?
- 3) What are the general considerations the board should keep in mind in arriving at a decision?

Session 14- Netflix: International Expansion (W16236) /Teams 5&6 (November 18th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) What is Netflix competitive advantage?
- 2) How can Netflix overcome its challenges in the international market?
- 3) What future strategic initiatives might Hastings consider?

Session 15- Levendary Café: The China challenge (4357) /Teams 1, 2 & 3 (November 25th)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) What is your evaluation of the way Levendary café has entered China?
- 2) What changes (if any) should Mia Foster do? What about changes at headquarters?

Session 16- UBER: Leading the sharing economy (W16087) /Teams 4, 5 & 6 (December 2nd)

Team presentations with Q&A session

Case discussion

- 1) Identify elements of the value chain. How do they each add value and cut costs?
- 2) Which generic business model did Uber emulate?
- 3) Identify the critical resources and activities Uber used to meet the desired business outcomes?

Individual evaluation of team member performance**GRADING**

30% Case presentations in class

20% Class participation

30% Standard exams (2)

20% Individual performance within teams (ranked by other team members)

**Attendance to 80% of the classes is a necessary pre requisite for taking the final exam*

CASE PRESENTATIONS

- 1) Sessions 2-7- One team per class will present
- 2) Sessions 9-14 – Two teams per class will present
- 3) Sessions 15 & 16 – Three teams per class will present

Format for case presentations:

-15 minutes presentation +5 minutes Q&A = 20 minutes per team

-Maximum of 12 slides handed in to the professor before class starts

-All presentations should be in Microsoft Power point format

-The first round of team presentations will be evaluated following the Case Checklist (below). The other three will be evaluated according to each case's questions (see each session /case)

TEXTBOOK

Transnational Management –Christopher A Bartlett & Paul W Beamish, Mc Graw-Hill 7thEdition (2013)

EBook version: Buy and download at:

<https://www.my ebooks-itam.com/>

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<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HiZJeTLgCx0>

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BIO INSTRUCTOR

Jose Luis Rivas is a full time professor and researcher at ITAM. With 17 years of full time work experience he held different executive positions at Inverlat securities and Grupo ADO where he was a board member for 8 years. While at ADO he also lived in Chiapas and Oaxaca.

Professor Rivas holds a PhD in management from IE Business School in Spain, an MBA from the Kellogg School of Management at Northwestern University in Chicago and a Bachelors in Business Administration from Anahuac University in Mexico City. He is a graduate from the International Teachers program at Bocconi University in Milan. He is Vicepresident of the Iberoamerican Academy of Management, member of the editorial board of *"Corporate Governance: An International Journal"* and the Mexican National System of researchers' level 1.

His research interests focus on boards of directors, internationalization and initial public offerings (IPOs). His work has been accepted for publication in international academic journals such as the *"International Journal of Human Resource Management"* and *"International Business Review"*.

CASE CHECKLIST

Global Strategy

****Each item is worth 2 points. Please write down the grade in the space provided and then add them up to have an overall score. Thank you for your help.***

Date _____

Team # _____

Members

Names _____

1) Problem / Issues _____

2) Causes and consequences of the problem _____

3) Generate alternatives _____

4) Decision criteria _____

5) Implementation plan _____

TOTAL _____

Comments: _____

